
BBC LEARNING ENGLISH

Real Easy English

Family



This is a transcript of a spoken conversation and is not a word-for-word script.

Neil

Welcome to Real easy English from BBC Learning English.

Beth

In this programme, we have real conversations in easy English to help you practise listening and learn new words and phrases. I'm Beth.

Neil

And I'm Neil. In each episode, we talk in English about a different topic that you need for everyday speaking. If you want to read along, you can visit our website: bbclearningenglish.com.

Hello, Beth.

Beth

Hi, Neil. How are you?

Neil

I'm very well, thank you. What are we talking about today?

Beth

Well, today's episode is all about family. We'll be talking about who is in our families and **comparing** them.

Neil

OK, great. So, what do we mean when we say **comparing** our families, Beth?

Beth

Well, when we **compare** two things, we look at them and see if they are the same or different and we can compare things in different ways, but we often do it with adjectives.

Neil

OK, let's start the conversation.

Beth

So, Neil, how big is your family?

Neil

It's probably average, really. I have one sister, but she has three kids and I have two kids. So, when we get together with my parents, there... there are a few of us. It's not... It's not tiny. It's not huge.

Beth

OK, yeah. I think my family is definitely **smaller** than yours because I don't have any brothers or sisters. I am an only child. So, when I get together with my family it's very small because I also only have one cousin and she's an only child as well. So my family's tiny!

Neil

OK. And what is your family like? It's small, but what's it like?

Beth

It is small, but we're very close. So, we see each other quite often. We are a bit silly. We like to go out and have food and play games and we can be quite loud, even though there aren't many of us.

Neil

OK, it sounds like you **get on well with** your family. Is that right?

Beth

Yeah, definitely. I love spending time with my cousin and she has two children.

What about you? Do you **get on well with** your sister?

Neil

Yes, I **get on well with** my sister. We don't see each other very often because we don't live in the same place. But when we see each other, we have a nice time. We catch up and chat.

So, Beth, we have used the expression **get on well with** someone. What does that mean?

Beth

Well, that means that you have a good relationship with them. So, if you **get on well with** your sister, it means when you're together you're happy, you're not fighting. It's easy to have good conversation. You don't really have any arguments. Maybe when you were a child, you didn't get on well with your sister. I don't know.

Neil

Yes, I think now that we're grown-ups it's easier to **get on well with** your siblings. When... When...When I was a kid, maybe I was a bit mean to her.

Beth

Oh dear!

So, Neil, your sister has three children.

Neil

Yeah.

Beth

What are the ages of them?

Neil

Well, for a start, they're all boys!

Beth

OK. Oh, my gosh. That sounds very difficult!

Neil

And the oldest one is 17 and he has just done his driving test. It's difficult to believe because, he's the **oldest**, he's always been the **oldest**, but now he's almost an adult.

Beth

And is he the **oldest** including your children?

Neil

Yeah

Beth

So out of all the kids he's the **oldest**?

Neil

He is, yeah.

Beth

So, in my family, my cousin has two children and they are five and two.

Neil

Ah! Little ones.

Beth

Yeah. They are the **youngest** in the family. But I was the **youngest** in my family until they came along and I am 32! So, I was used to being the **youngest**, but I'm not the **youngest** anymore, now we've got little ones.

Neil

Oh well! Are you sad?

Beth

No, I'm OK.

Neil

OK, let's quickly recap the vocabulary we learned in this conversation.

Beth

We learnt **compare** which means to look at two things to see if they are the same or different.

Neil

Bigger and **smaller**, which are ways to compare the size of something.

Beth

Youngest and **oldest** which are ways to talk about the age of someone or something.

Neil

And we looked at **get on well with** someone, which means to have a good relationship with them.

Beth

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Neil

Next time, we'll talk about food and some of our favourite meals to eat.

Beth

Mmm, delicious! See you, then. Bye!

Neil

Goodbye!